

Felix RUSCHE

Senior Research Fellow, Max Planck Institute for Behavioral Economics

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CURRENT POSITION

today | **MAX PLANCK INSTITUTE FOR BEHAVIORAL ECONOMICS**, Bonn, Germany
Sep 2025 | Senior Research Fellow (Postdoc)

AFFILIATIONS

2026 - today | Associated Member, ECONtribute Cluster of Excellence, Universities of Cologne and Bonn
2021 - 2025 | Fellow, Collaborative Research Center 224, Universities of Bonn and Mannheim

EDUCATION

May 2025 | **UNIVERSITY OF MANNHEIM**, Mannheim, Germany
Sep 2019 | Economics, Ph.D. (Dr. rer. Pol.), summa cum laude

Jun 2023 | **POMPEU FABRA UNIVERSITY**, Barcelona, Spain
Jan 2023 | Research Stay

Feb 2019 | **UNIVERSITY OF MANNHEIM**, Mannheim, Germany
Sep 2016 | Economics, M.Sc., GPA : 1.3

Jul 2018 | **BOCCONI UNIVERSITY**, Milan, Italy
Feb 2018 | Visiting Student

Mar 2016 | **OSNABRÜCK UNIVERSITY OF APPLIED SCIENCES**, Osnabrück, Germany
Sep 2012 | Applied Economics, B.A., GPA : 1.37

Nov 2014 | **NELSON MANDELA UNIVERSITY**, Port Elizabeth, South Africa
Jul 2014 | Visiting Student

PUBLICATIONS

LinkedOut? A Field Experiment on Discrimination in Job Network Formation *with Yulia Evsyukova and Wladislaw Mill*
The Quarterly Journal of Economics, 2025

- *Best Scientific Publication in 2024/25 – ZEW 2025*
- *Schmölder Award – Verein für Socialpolitik 2025*

Few Voices, Strong Echo : Measuring Follower Homogeneity of Politicians' Twitter Accounts
New Media & Society, 2024

Publications as Contributing Author

Investigating the analytical robustness of the social and behavioural sciences *with >450 co-authors/-analysts*
Nature, 2026

WORKING PAPERS

Broadcasting Change : India's Community Radio Policy and Women's Empowerment

- *Best paper in gender economics – Unicredit Foundation 2025*
- *Best paper in public policy evaluation – Bruno Kessler Foundation (IRVAPP) 2025*
- *Best applied paper – Econometric Society Europe Meeting 2024*

Stock Market Performance in the Media : Reporting the Big News, Missing the Big Picture? *with Antonio Ciccone*

SELECTED WORK IN PROGRESS

Discrimination against toddlers : A nationwide field experiment (experiment ongoing) *with Wladislaw Mill*

Learning about own discriminatory preferences (data analysis) *with Wladislaw Mill*

4G internet and educational attainment : evidence from India (early draft) *with Fabian Reutzel*

GRANTS, AWARDS, AND SCHOLARSHIPS

2023 - 2027	Add-on Fellowship for Interdisciplinary Research in Economics, Joachim Herz Foundation (12,500€ grant)
2025	Schmölder Award, Verein für Socialpolitik (German Economic Association) (3,000€)
2025	Award for the best paper in gender economics, Unicredit Foundation (2,500€)
2025	Award for the best paper in public policy evaluation, FBK/IRVAPP (1,000€)
2025	Best Scientific Publication in 2024/25 Award, Centre for European Economic Research, ZEW (2,000€)
2025	First Prize – Goldmedia Award for innovative dissertations in Media Economics (500€)
2021-25	CRC TR 224 : funding of research stay and various conference visits (approx. 20,000€)
2024	Award for best applied paper at the Econometric Society's Europe Meeting 2024
2024	CRC TR 224 Research Grant for an experiment (4,000€)
2021	CRC TR 224 Research Grant for an experiment (4,000€)
2019 - 2021	PhD Scholarship, Freudenberg Foundation & ZEW (30,000€)
2020	Second Prize – Goldmedia Award for innovative theses in Media Economics (400€)
2014 - 2019	German National Academic Foundation (Studienstiftung des deutschen Volkes) - Scholarship for 'academic excellence, interdisciplinary expertise, and social responsibility' (30,000€+ and ideational support)
2016	StudyUp-Award for excellent bachelor's theses, Osnabrück University of Applied Sciences (500€)

PROFESSIONAL ACTIVITIES

Presentations	2026-27 (incl scheduled) : Tilburg University, ESA World Meeting, EEA Annual Meeting, Southern Economic Association Annual Meeting, Duisburg-Essen University, ECONtribute Applied Micro Workshop; 2025 : CEPR Annual Symposium (Paris), Chicago Economics Experimental Summer School (Bonn), Workshop on Networks and Development (Naples), University of Gothenburg, MPI Behavioral Economics (Bonn), IRVAPP Summer School (Bertinoro), LISER Luxemburg, ifo Institute (Munich), Bocconi University (University & LEAP, Milan); 2024 : ASSA Annual Meeting (San Antonio), Federal Communications Commission (FCC) Economic Seminars, Asia Meeting of the Econometric Society (Hangzhou), Europe Meeting of the Econometric Society (Rotterdam), Royal Economic Society Annual Conference (Belfast), ifo Digital Transformation & Innovation Seminar (Munich), Joachim Herz Foundation (Hamburg), CRC TR224 YR Workshop (Bonn & Mannheim), FHM+ Workshop in Development Economics (Mannheim); 2023 : NBER Summer Institute : Labor Studies, Advances with Field Experiments (Chicago), Discrimination and Diversity Workshop (University of East Anglia), Institute of Labor Economics (IZA), Pompeu Fabra University (PhD & Internal Applied Seminar), London Business School Transatlantic Doctoral Conference, Nordic Conference in Development Economics (Gothenburg), German Development Economics Conference, German Economic Association Annual Conference, Barcelona School of Economics PhD Jamboree, HeiKaMaXY Workshop (Heidelberg), CRC TR224 Retreat (U Bonn & Mannheim); 2022 : CRC TR224 YR Workshop (Bonn & Mannheim), Frankfurt-Mannheim PhD Workshop; 2020 : Bonn-Mannheim PhD Workshop; 2019 : ZEW Conference on the Economics of Information and Communication Technologies
Refereeing	Quarterly Journal of Economics (3x); International Economic Review; Journal of Comparative Economics; Information, Communication & Society (2x); New Media & Society; Frontiers in Behavioral Economics
Media & Policy	2025 : contributions to Ideas for India, VoxEU, Media@LSE blog; interview with Mannheimer Morgen; presentation at the ZDF's economic and financial unit (German public television); 2024 : contributions to Frankfurter Allgemeine Zeitung, economics that really matters; presentation at Federal Communications Commission
Events	2023 : Co-organizer of the 1st Frankfurt-Mannheim-Bonn Ph.D. Conference (90 presentations, 160 participants) 2022 : Co-organizer of the 1st Frankfurt-Mannheim Ph.D. Workshop (43 presentations, 100 participants)
Field Research	Independent field research on community radios across northern India (03/2022 - 04/2022)
Summer Schools	2025 : Chicago School in Experimental Economics (Bonn edition); 2024 : Add-on Meeting on Science Communication (Joachim Herz Foundation); 2023 : CRC Media Training (EconNewsNetwork), Data Science Summer School 2023 (Hertie School); 2022 : Network Analysis Workshop (LMU Munich), Natural Language Processing for Economists Workshop (Uni Heidelberg), Data Science Summer School 2022 (Hertie School); 2021 : Unstructured Data in Empirical Economics (CEMFI), Data Science Summer School 2021 (Hertie School)

TEACHING EXPERIENCE AND RESEARCH ASSISTANCE

- 2026 (scheduled)** Labor Economics (master), lecturer, University of Bonn (summer term)
2021 - 2025 Research assistant to Antonio Ciccone, University of Mannheim
2021 Microeconomics B (bachelor), teaching assistant, University of Mannheim
2021 Introduction to Econometrics (bachelor), teaching assistant, University of Mannheim
2019 Master's thesis student/intern, Digital Economy Research Department, Leibniz Centre for European Economic Research (ZEW), Mannheim, Germany

EXTRACURRICULARS

- 2019 - 2025** Ph.D. Cohort Representative
2019 - 2023 Elected member of the Department Council, University of Mannheim
2021 - 2022 Mentor, Graduate Applications International Network (GAIN), application support of an African economics student
2015 - 2019 Seminars of the German National Merit Foundation : [1] Two-year social science research seminar 2017-19 – Digitization, Ethics, and Society : An Integrative Analysis, [2] Seminar 2017 – Effective Altruism : Risks of Artificial Intelligence, [3] Seminar 2016 – Freedom vs. Security : The Internet as a new Space for an Enduring Conflict, [4] Summer School 2015 – Narratives of the Future : Visionary Utopia or Botch ?
2018 - 2019 Board Member of 'Nice to Meet You', Uni Mannheim - student refugee integration project.
2015 - 2016 'Campus Without Borders' in Osnabrück : setup of a student refugee integration project.

NON-ACADEMIC PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

- 03/2015 - 07/2015** Internship, Political Department, German Embassy Beijing, China
07/2013 - 09/2013 Internship, Strategic Finance, Deutsche Börse AG, Frankfurt am Main, Germany
07/2011 - 09/2011 Internship, Various Business Departments, Frimo Inc, Detroit, USA

MISCELLANEOUS

- Citizenship** German
Languages German (native), English (fluent – TOEFL 2019 : 114 of 120 points / Top 3%), Spanish (B1)
Technical Skills R, Python, Stata, Qualtrics, QGIS

REFERENCES

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